

Investor profile

NAME: Nicky (pseudonym)

AGE: 30

JOB: Software engineer

SALARY: US\$300 000

1. What does your investment portfolio look like?

US\$400 000 in a simple three-fund portfolio: VTSAX (49 per cent), VTIAAX (21 per cent), VBTLX (25 per cent). This is in addition to my retirement accounts and company RSUs (restricted stock units). Trying to actively sell my RSUs to reduce the proportion of single stock in my portfolio but it's hard because of the capital gains accrued.

2. How much and how often do you invest?

On average \$3000 monthly.

3. Why do you invest?

So I can have more control of my time in the future. I want to live a FI (Financially independent) life when I don't 'have to' work for money anymore.

4. Any tips for new investors?

Keep it simple: instead of investing in ad hoc single company stocks, try to have a well-balanced portfolio with asset allocation according to your age.

Make sure you are using all the tax advantaged accounts you can. Not only your 401(k)s, but also the IRAs and the after tax accounts ('Megabackdoor'). Power of compounding along with no taxes on growth makes a big big difference in how much your money grows over a period of time. They should teach this in school!

(Especially for young girls) investing and money can sometimes be taboo topics. It might seem superficial to talk about money. There